From Atlanta, a hand back home.

The AJA has backed students of Jamaican heritage, in Atlanta and in Jamaica, for decades. Hack876 gives Kingston students one day to build something real, and a reason to know the diaspora is cheering them on.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY THE AJA

The AJA Scholarship has helped students of Jamaican heritage, in metro Atlanta and in Jamaica, since 1995.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

A Bronze contribution from the Association, or pooled from its members.

Bronze Partner: J$50,000 to below J$200,000. Any amount within the level is welcome.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Helps support an existing special award and the student programme on the day.

WHAT THE AJA RECEIVES

Bronze recognition, a written recap the AJA can share with members, and Hack876 organisers reporting back at a monthly meeting.

THE NEXT STEP

A reply from the President on whether to bring this to the membership, and at which monthly meeting.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

01 WHY THE AJA

Roots in Jamaica. Community in Atlanta. Students in both.

Hack876 is a chance for Atlanta's Jamaican community to cheer on students back home on the day they build something of their own.

THE ATLANTA JAMAICAN ASSOCIATION, MISSION

"The mission of the Atlanta Jamaican Association, Inc. (AJA) is to foster goodwill and understanding among Jamaicans and all peoples in metro Atlanta, through civic, economic, cultural, and philanthropic programs and activities; and to provide assistance to Jamaicans living in the area and in Jamaica."[2]

Since 1995, the AJA Scholarship has helped graduating seniors of Jamaican heritage, in metro Atlanta and in Jamaica, with first-year college costs. Over 100 students have received awards.[3]

Since 2016, the AJA has given $200K in scholarships and aid, and more than 150 students have received its help with university studies.[4]

Its outreach to Jamaica has included books, supplies and equipment for basic schools.[5]

WHAT THE AJA ALREADY DOES

1977

The Atlanta Jamaican Association is founded on October 8, and is incorporated the next year. Today it is the oldest Jamaican organization in metro Atlanta.[2]

1995

The AJA Scholarship begins, run with the AJ Cultural & Educational Fund, for students of Jamaican heritage in metro Atlanta and in Jamaica.[3]

2016

The start of a run that has since reached $200K in scholarships and aid for students.[4]

2021

Rep Yuh Parish launches, with members funding projects in their home parishes in Jamaica.[5]

02 OUR REQUEST

Become a Bronze Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

BRONZE PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

It is small and concrete, close in spirit to the scholarships the AJA already gives, and it lets members see exactly what their support did.

WHAT IT HELPS SUPPORT

- **Special awards.** Helps support an existing special award.
- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT THE AJA WOULD RECEIVE

- **Recognition on the Hack876 website**
- **Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you**
- **Named in the post-event recap**
- **A written recap after the event**

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner (SUGGESTED)	Silver Partner	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

Who is running it, and what we need from you.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

Schools: 2 confirmed, 1 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed, from a network of 9 in Kingston. Partners and donors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day. Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

Evette Taylor-Reynolds began a teaching career at Campion College, according to the 2026 Marcus Garvey Symposium programme. Both Hack876 organisers are Campion alumni.[7] Status with Hack876: confirmed.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A reply from the President on whether to bring this to the membership, and at which monthly meeting.

The AJA meets on the second Saturday of each month at 6:00 p.m., except August and December, and welcomes all. The President can be reached at president@atlantajamaicanassociation.org.[2]

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · **info@hack876.com** · **Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min**

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ **How many students, teams and schools took part**
- ✓ **What the teams built, with the finalist projects described**
- ✓ **How your contribution was used**
- ✓ **Photos, only where schools and parents have consented**

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

Contribution levels, and what each receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement on the website and event signage
- A dedicated sponsor feature**
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- Everything in Gold
- The most prominent placement on the website and event signage

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

**The form of the sponsor feature is agreed with each Gold or Platinum partner before it is confirmed.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

In-kind & Community Support: For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES

1. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "2026 Board of Directors." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/board

2. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "About Us: mission, history, lasting impact, meetings and contact." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/about-1

3. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "The AJA Scholarship." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/scholarship

4. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "Home: our impact." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/

5. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "Our Impact: outreach to Jamaica and Rep Yuh Parish." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/our-impact

6. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "News & Events: highlights from the 2026 Independence Ball & Scholarship Awards." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/news

7. Big Bethel AME Church, "3rd Annual Atlanta Marcus Garvey Symposium programme (March 25, 2026): AJA President bio." www.bigbethelame.org/_files/ugd/c3808e_8b54c0820b7d448a902c52ad3ee5df95.pdf

A private partnership proposal prepared for Evette Taylor-Reynolds, President, The Atlanta Jamaican Association.